systems. As one of the causes of the destruction of this particular variety of literature, the hypothesis of the fanatic persecution of the unorthodox cannot be ruled out. As to the special claim of idealism in our philosophy, there is no more of it than is to be found in Western philosophy.

Closely allied to the claim of idealism or spiritualism in Indian philosophy is the not of Asceticism in Indian life. It is often proclaimed that the stress in Indian thought, in general, is on renunciation rather than on fulfillment and that a man is judged more by what he gives up rather than by what he accepts. It is not necessary to dwell upon this point, for everyone, I believe, understands the higher status given to the concepts of *tapas*, austerity, sacrifice, non-attachment and the like. To the extent this note of asceticism or renunciation stands for the inevitable truth inherent in all higher orders of life and existence, it is found to be as much a fundamental of Indian philosophy as in the basic teaching of European or Western thought. Hence, to make any philosophical capital out of asceticism in Indian thought is both to misunderstand it and to misrepresent it.

Another point often sought to be made about the peculiarity of Indian philosophy is that it is practical or that it is a way of life or realization. It is said that philosophy in India has not been pursued merely because of man's love of wisdom or the satisfaction of the demands of his intellect. It has a deeply practical motive, which is the attainment of *mokṣa*, or liberation, or the absolute cessation of the three-fold *dukkha*, or suffering.

A little reflection on Indian philosophy and its practical effect upon the lives of men in India would hardly justify the above claim. While it is true that life rather than thought and that being rather than knowing has always been regarded as more important and worthwhile in India, this has not been due to any special characteristics of the philosophical thought. This practical bias is due more to the dominance of the religious and the affective attitude than to the force of philosophical thought. The same is true of men in the West or anywhere else, where religious or secular sentiments and aspirations sway their minds. Philosophy as a dispassionate and reasoned understanding of things has nowhere made men excel in the realm of action or led them to alter the basic patterns of their lives. For that you need something much less than pure thought, or if you like, something of a different stuff. All that is practical in philosophy is necessarily suspect as pure or good philosophy. No effective action is possible nor practical result achieved without an amount of fanaticism or uncritical be-